beginTransmission()

Because we can have so many devices connected on a single data bus, we need to identify the device that we intend to write data to using `beginTransmission()`.

```
Wire.beginTransmission(address)
```

The single parameter is the address of the slave device specified in the devices data sheet that we want to transmit data to. This function will create a queue for the `write()` function to temporarily place data into. In our example code, it is as follows:

```
Wire.beginTransmission(DS1307);
```

We defined the variable `DS1307` at the beginning of our sketch to contain the address of `0x68` for the DS1307 device. The function needs to be called to transmit data to that device and then ended before sending data to another device on the I2C bus.

endTransmission()

The `endTransmission` closes the communication with a slave device that was opened with the `beginTransmission()` function. This function will also send the data that was previously queued up using the `write()` function.

write()

After opening a connection to a slave device, we can then use the `write()` function to send bytes of data to the device. The syntax depends on the type of data that we want to send, as follows:

```
Wire.write(value)
Wire.write(string)
Wire.write(value, quantity)
```

The data to be written can include a `byte` or `char` data type and we can optionally set the number of bytes to be sent. In our example code we used this a couple of ways, as follows:

```
Wire.write(byte(0));
Wire.write(decToBcd(second));
```

The first statement is used in our examples in several places, usually to wake up the device and let it know that we are waiting to read data. It is also used in the Time Clock Setting source code to set the date and time by writing the seconds, minutes, hours, and units one byte at a time to the device. We needed to specify the data type `byte()` in the first example to avoid any problems with ambiguity in the data type.

requestFrom()

We've opened up a channel to our device and written data to it. Now let's look at how to get data from an I2C device. To start, we need to request that data be sent from the device using the `requestFrom()` function. It's syntax follows:

```
Wire.requestFrom(address, quantity)
```